



AdvocateDadCO

#AdvocateDad | Western Colorado

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Two issues. Two asks.

Rob and Isabelle Harris are bringing a focused federal agenda and complementary family, rural-implementation, and lived-experience perspectives to federal education advocacy. Public materials focus on the policy asks rather than private travel, meeting, or participant details.

ROB HARRIS

Father, caregiver, [Colorado Department of Education](#) Certified Individualized Education Program Facilitator, and systems advocate. Rob explains what federal infrastructure looks like when a rural family must reach scarce blindness expertise.

ISABELLE HARRIS

A blind young-adult self-advocate, Braille reader, assistive-technology user, and white-cane traveler. Isabelle speaks from her own experience about access, instruction, mobility, and transition.

THE CONGRESSIONAL AGENDA

01

Protect the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act - including Part D

Protect funding for every part of the [Individuals with Disabilities Education Act](#) in final fiscal year 2027 appropriations. Preserve Part D national activities supporting personnel preparation, technical assistance, parent training and family information, accessible technology and materials, and specialized expertise.

02

Support and advance Senate bill 5046

Keep the [Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services](#) and other core education functions within the [U.S. Department of Education](#) so monitoring, technical assistance, coordination, and specialized expertise remain connected to the broader education system.

WHY LOW-INCIDENCE INFRASTRUCTURE MATTERS

A district may serve one deafblind student - or go years without serving one - and still must meet its obligations under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act when that student arrives. Federal investment helps sustain the personnel pipeline, technical assistance, family information, accessible materials, and specialized networks that no individual community can reasonably recreate alone.

THE BROADER ADVOCATEDADCO MISSION

Access from Day One. Build and Support the Workforce. Share Power With the People Affected. These standing commitments support the message; they are not additional Congressional asks.

"Federal infrastructure matters most when individual communities cannot recreate specialized expertise themselves."

Rob Harris | AdvocateDadCO

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